

for now, and think about near-audiophile-quality sound with near-complete noise isolation. You'll absolutely love the sound, and might just ditch your speakers! This set retails at approximately \$200 (Rs 9,500). Go ahead, indulge your ears!

1.3.1 Headphone Amplifiers

The phones we've talked about need amplifiers, on account of their high impedance. Some from headphone.com have a "cross-feed" feature whereby music will sound binaural. (It won't technically be binaural as in a binaural recording, but still.) Think about this: when you're listening to speakers, *both* your ears are listening to *all* the speakers. But when you're using headphones, the left ear hears only what's coming through on the left—and the same for the right ear. With crossfeed, the amplifier inserts a little time delay and feeds the *right* sound into the *left* ear, at a lower volume, and feeds the left sound into the right ear. Both your ears will therefore be listening to all the sound! You literally won't believe your ears when you turn the button on for the first time—you'll feel your headphones have "opened up," and that you're listening to speakers! It sounds much, much natural, and you'll wonder what on earth you were doing listening to terrible monaural sound for all these years!

The amplifiers are worth it just for the crossfeed switch, in our opinion. But remember that for high-impedance headphones such as the Sennheiser HD600 and Grado RS-1, you'll *need* the amplifier if you're listening from a portable music source.

Head to headphone.com and click the "Amps" tab. You'll find that those in the AirHead series (in The Mobile Line) and those in The Micro Line are reasonably affordable—for those serious enough about music, that is.